6.3 Digestive System

Digestive system consists of the alimentary canal and associated glands. This system is involved in the conversion of complex food substances into simple forms and absorption of digested food.

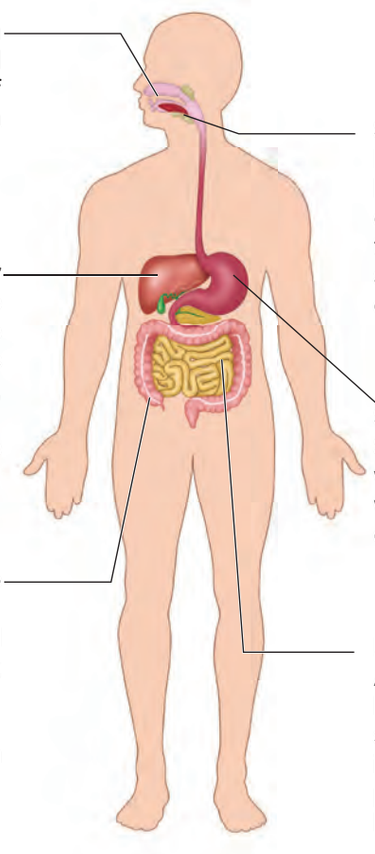
The digestive glands associated with the alimentary canal are salivary glands, liver, and pancreas. They secrete enzymes which help in the process of digestion of food in the digestive tract or alimentary canal.

The alimentary canal is about 9 meters long. Stomach is a major organ for digestion of food materials. Absorption of digested food occurs in the small intestine.

Parts of Alimentary canal	
1.	Mouth
2.	Buccal cavity
3.	Pharynx
4.	Oesophagus or Food pipe
5.	Stomach
6.	Small Intestine
7.	Large Intestine
8.	Anus

Associated glands for digestion	
1.	Salivary glands
2.	Gastric glands
3.	Liver
4.	Pancreas
5.	Intestinal glands

Digestive System



Mouth
Starts mechanical and chemical digestion of food with the help of teeth, tongue and saliva

Liver
Blood carrying nutrients from the small intestine passes through the liver, which filters it and breaks down and synthesizes proteins, converts glucose into glycogen, and also produces bile

Small intestine
A long tube about six metres in which most of chemical digestion occurs; nutrients are absorbed from here into the bloodstream

Salivary glands
Produces saliva, which helps to lubricate food for easier swallowing; contains antibacterial agents and the enzyme salivary amylase, which breaks down strach

Stomach
Stores, mixes, and digests food with the gastric juice it produces, which consists of mucus, enzymes,and hydrochloric acid.

Large intestine
Absorbs water from the food that have not been digested in the small intestine; also absorbs some important vitamins that are produced by the large number of bacteria it harbours

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